

1. Introducing wrapture

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-31T23:59:36+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/31/introducing-wrapture/>

Introducing wrapture New from Graham Dumpleton (of wrapt , mod_wsgi, and New Relic's Python agent fame), who describes Wrapture as taking the monkeypatching ideas from wrapt and extending them to apply to testing and tracing at the same time. Wrapture (full documentation here) makes it easy to wrap any function or method such that all access can be traced, or can be overridden to return a different value. It acts as both an alternative to unittest.mock and a way to implement tracing against an existing project: Attaching observation to code you do not control, recording what flows through it, and doing so without disturbing the program being watched, is a problem I have never really stopped thinking about. Wrapture includes OpenTelemetry support and even has an entirely configuration-based mechanism for adding tracing to an existing Python project, which looks like this: `capture = " summary " [[ observe ]]`
`target = " domain:Calculator " name = [ " outer " , " inner " ] [[ sink ]]` `type = " jsonlines "`
`path = " trace.jsonl "` This is still a very young project - just a few weeks old - but it's off to a very promising start. Interestingly, this is also Graham's first attempt at larg...

2. Quoting Andrew Digby

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-31T22:25:02+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/31/andrew-digby/>

325 #kakapo! The chicks from this year's record breeding season are now juveniles and so have been added to the population. In 1995 there were just 51 k?k?p? left. Recovery of critically endangered species is possible with sustained effort. ? Andrew Digby , providing the best news of the year Tags: kakapo

3. ?Not Sure How You Own Canada by Deleting Your Own History?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-28T16:25:33Z

Link: <https://x.com/MattWalshBlog/status/2093060290371870948>

Matt Walsh, described by Wikipedia as ?an American far-right political commentator and podcast host? (a description that sounds harsh, but I'd say is describing him euphemistically), on Twitter/X (retweeting the official White House account?s announcement of the name change): This will be an unpopular opinion on the Right but I think this is kind of dumb, even as a troll. Lake Ontario was given that name on maps by European explorers long before the Canadian province of Ontario was named. There are several cities in America called Ontario ? at least one of them predating the Canadian province by like 100 years ? because the word originates with native tribes in North America. It?s not a Canadian invention. Canadians never uniquely owned the lake or the name. So in effect all you?re doing here is actually giving them credit for a thing that wasn?t theirs to begin with. Yeah it?s funny when Canadians are upset I guess or whatever, but Lake Ontario, the name itself, is American history dating back many centuries. Not sure how you own Canada by deleting your own history. Politically this is also stupid because the number one challenge Republicans will face in the midterms is the char...

4. From the DF Archive: ?Golfo Del Gringo Loco?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-28T15:00:39Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2025/02/golfo_del_gringo_loco

Yours truly back in February 2025: The motivation behind the name change is simple as well. Trump didn?t change the US?s officially recognized name of, say, the Atlantic Ocean or the continent of Africa. He just as easily could, but he won?t. I?m starting to worry how well that?s going to hold up . And it?s not like ?Gulf of Mexico? was on a list of ?debatable or controversial names? until he created this controversy out of thin air. It?s just the one name on the globe that a president of the United States can change to stick it to Mexico, a country Donald Trump has objectively racist feelings toward . Trump never campaigned on building a wall

at our northern border with Canada, nor has he (yet?) attempted to rename Lake Ontario. That (yet?) held up very well, alas. The rest of my essay holds up very well too, I think, especially pertaining to how Google and Apple present the change in their respective maps apps: So whether Google and Apple should show the new name at all shouldn't be the question we're asking. The right question is necessarily more nuanced: Who should see which names, where? And Google and Apple's answers to that question are, alas, disappointing and worrisome....

5. Trump Declares That Lake Ontario Is Now 'Lake America'

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-28T14:02:53Z

Link: <https://www.notus.org/trump-white-house/lake-america-ontario-canada-trade-war-trump-executive-order-rename>

Jackie Llanos and Jenna Monnin, reporting for NOTUS: President Donald Trump on Thursday signed an executive order meant to rename Lake Ontario 'Lake America,' taking his apparent jab at Canada one step further as a trade war between the two countries escalates. The president said the name change was 'effective immediately' during a signing ceremony in the Oval Office. The executive order directs Interior Secretary Doug Burgum to update the Geographic Names Information Service to reflect the name change. When asked by reporters about the move, Trump said he was sending 'no message' to Canada with the name change. 'Lake of America was something I've been thinking about for a long time,' the president said. 'Actually, as you know, we took something called the Gulf of Mexico, we changed it, and now it's very routinely the Gulf of America.' Aaron Rupar has video clips of Trump declaring the change in an Oval Office press event, [here](#) and [here](#). In the second clip Trump ruminates, 'So if you think about it, we have a gulf, and we have a lake, now all we need is an ocean, so maybe we'll have to change the name of the Atlantic and/or the Pacific. Maybe we'll change them both.' Those who de...

6. Here's a good way to present AI videos

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Mon, 31 Aug 2026 07:30:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/a-good-way-to-present-ai-videos-on-youtube>

The YouTube tag marking a video as AI-generated is as insignificant as the little "Sponsored" text in search ads. I've taught my mother and her friends to check for that tag, but most, if not all, of the videos they share with me don't even have it. Even though they're clearly AI-generated. If deception is something we want to prevent, and our parents can't tell real videos from fake ones, wouldn't it make sense to put a warning where it's actually effective? Just like movies have warnings beforehand, why not add one before these videos? It would take no more than two or three seconds, and it's entirely controlled by the platform. If someone is willing to watch the content after the warning, more power to them. But for those being deceived, this would actually help. Those are the words YouTube places on videos where it detects AI, but they're buried somewhere in the description. Why not make that notice prominent when the video starts, the same way some videos open with a "Viewer discretion is advised" notice? On YouTube or whichever platform hosting the video, the warning is not embedding into the video, just displayed before. The uploader has no control over it. While I know mos...

7. AWE does not require PAE, though PAE makes it much more useful

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 31 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260831-00/?p=112660>

All dressed up with nowhere to go. The post AWE does not require PAE, though PAE makes it much more useful appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. Cancellation Terminology

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-08-31T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/08/31/cancellation-terminology.html>

A short note explaining the difference between synchronous cancellation, asynchronous cancellation, and graceful shutdown. I am not too attached to these specific three terms, but I want to call your attention to the three things behind them, which are important not to confuse

with each other.

9. Patented application of linear algebra

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Mon, 31 Aug 2026 23:26:12 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/31/patented-application-of-linear-algebra/>

I just found out Brian Beckman and I got a patent on work we did for GSI Technology [1]. Nearly all the work I do is under an NDA, so I don't often get a chance to talk about my projects.

This work is public now that it's in a patent; I suppose it has [?] The post Patented application of linear algebra first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Review: Ruined Theatre's A Midsummer Night's Dream ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Mon, 31 Aug 2026 11:34:08 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/review-ruined-theatres-a-midsummer-nights-dream/>

The whole point about Shakespeare is that you can set the play on an intergalactic space station or an American high school and keep virtually the rest unchanged. What happens when you transpose Dream from a proscenium arch to a living wood? As the sun sets over the trees, what sprites will come out to entertain us? Ruined Theatre brings a brilliant cast of seasoned West End performers to strut?

11. Notes from August 2026

Source: Evan Hahn (dot com) | Published: Mon, 31 Aug 2026 06:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://evanhahn.com/notes-from-august-2026/>

Since last month , I released some new stuff at work, clicked a bunch of links, and wrote a little bit. Things I did this August At Ghost, we added analytics for automated email sequences . This helps publishers see how their sequences are doing. This simple feature turned out to be pretty tricky under the hood. Learned that Vim has a joke trigger called UserGettingBored . I continued to write for Zelda Dungeon, including an interview with a very cool ROM hack developer . Links I clicked ?Libertarian futurists weren't the only people proposing new rules for cyberspace; they just happened to be the people who ended up making the rules.? From ?Democracy v the machine? . ?If civil society is to remain free and vibrant, people must be able to organize, speak and connect without fear of being watched.? Learned that most Americans hate data centers. I learned this from a poll and podcast episode . I appreciated this overview of digital accessibility technologies . I definitely didn't know about all of these. I think SQLite is incredible, and this talk describes how they make it so reliable . Goes against some maxims I believe?heavy code comments, having ~20% of your ?real? code be just...

12. The rise and fall of agent civilizations

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Mon, 31 Aug 2026 20:36:53 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/openai-huggingface-narration>

The OpenAI/Hugging Face attack, clearly explained

13. Reducing codebase cognitive debt through... quizzes?

Source: Martin Alderson | Published: Mon, 31 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: https://martinalderson.com/posts/codebase-cognitive-debt-quizzes/?utm_source=rss&utm_medium=rss&utm_campaign=feed

A simple technique for keeping up with a codebase that coding agents are changing faster than you can read: ask the agent to quiz you on it.